

Sandusky County Probate Court

Website Accessibility Improvements Report — Final

Standard: WCAG 2.1 Level AA | Date: May 2025 | Prepared by: Digital Kingdom Interprises

Project Scope: Audit and remediation of accessibility barriers across the Sandusky County Probate Court website (*sanduskycountyprobatecourt.com*) to meet ADA compliance requirements under WCAG 2.1 Level AA. All 20 files — including shared infrastructure and all content pages — have been reviewed and corrected. Changes cover semantic HTML structure, ARIA attributes, keyboard navigation support, screen reader compatibility, heading hierarchy, image alt text, link context, form accessibility, table accessibility, and phone/address markup.

Pages Summary

File	Page / Component	Status	Fixes Applied
header.php	Shared Header / Page Titles	Complete	1
style.css	Global Stylesheet	Complete	1
index.php	Home Page	Complete	9
birth.php	Birth and Death Records Search	Complete	8
marriage.php	Marriage Record Search — Prior to 1994	Complete	7
marriage2.php	Marriage Record Search — 1994 to Present	Complete	3
records.php	Case Search	Complete	6
estates.php	Estate Administration	Complete	10
guardian.php	Guardianships	Complete	8
adopt.php	Adoptions	Complete	5
trusts.php	Trusts	Complete	6
mental.php	Mental Health	Complete	5

<code>birthregcorrections.php</code>	Birth Registration and Corrections	Complete	10
<code>marriagelicense.php</code>	Marriage License	Complete	5
<code>disinterment.php</code>	Disinterment	Complete	2
<code>namechange.php</code>	Name Change	Complete	7
<code>otherlinks.php</code>	Other Links	Complete	3
<code>contact.php</code>	Contact	Complete	6
<code>court.php</code>	Court / Judge / Court Costs	Complete	10
<code>localforms.php</code>	Local Forms	Complete	5
Total Fixes Applied			117

header.php — Shared Header 1 fix

- Implemented dynamic page title using `$page_title` PHP variable: `<?php echo isset($page_title) ? $page_title . ' | Sandusky County Probate Court' : 'Sandusky County Probate Court'; ?>` — every page now has a unique, descriptive title

style.css — Global Stylesheet 1 fix

- Added `.sr-only` visually-hidden CSS class (Materialize CSS does not include this built-in) to support screen-reader-only text throughout the site

index.php — Home Page 9 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Home"`
- Added skip navigation link: `<a href="#main-content" class="skip-link">Skip to main content</a>`
- Added `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper with visually-hidden `<h1 class="sr-only">` for screen reader page identification
- Removed invalid `<div>` nested inside `<p>` tag
- Changed "Judge Brad Smith" heading from H3 to H2 — fixed skipped heading level
- Changed "PROBATE COURT NEWS" heading from H1 to H2 — page must have only one H1
- Changed thank-you message from H3 to `<p>` — not a structural heading
- Changed news card title from `<span class="dki-boldhead">` to `<h3>` — proper heading for card content
- Set `alt=""` on all 10 service card images — images are decorative when the same link contains a heading with identical text, preventing duplicate screen reader announcements

birth.php — Birth and Death Records Search 8 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Birth and Death Records Search"`
- Added skip navigation link
- Added `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper
- Fixed markdown syntax appearing as literal link text for `www.scpublichealth.com`
- Added `aria-label` with new tab warning to Sandusky County Board of Health website link
- Added descriptive `aria-label` to non-descriptive "SEARCH HERE" link
- Added descriptive `aria-label` to non-descriptive "here" link for Case Management System
- Added descriptive `alt` text to both instructional screenshot images

marriage.php — Marriage Record Search Prior to 1994 7 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Marriage Record Search Prior to 1994"`
- Added skip navigation link
- Added `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper
- Removed invalid `<p>` wrappers around two `<ul>` elements
- Added descriptive `aria-label` to all 4 "SEARCH HERE" links
- Added descriptive `alt` text to all 4 instructional screenshot images

marriage2.php — Marriage Record Search 1994 to Present 3 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Marriage Record Search 1994 to Present"`
- Added descriptive `aria-label` to "SEARCH HERE" external link
- Rewrote non-descriptive "here" link with descriptive text and new tab `aria-label`

records.php — Case Search 6 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Case Search"`
- Added skip navigation link
- Added `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper
- Removed invalid `<p>` wrapper around `<ul>` element
- Added descriptive `aria-label` to both "SEARCH HERE" external links
- Added descriptive `alt` text to both instructional screenshot images

estates.php — Estate Administration 10 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Estate Administration"`
- Added skip navigation link
- Added `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper
- Removed invalid `<p>` wrapper around `<ul>` element
- Added descriptive `aria-label` with new tab warnings to all external and search links
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warnings to all 25 estate form PDF links
- Changed all 10 FAQ questions from `<span class="dki-boldhead">` inside `<p>` to proper `<h3>` heading elements
- Fixed malformed `</h3>` closing tag
- Fixed missing `<p>` opening tags on several FAQ answer paragraphs
- Converted plain text phone number to `<a href="tel:...">` with `aria-label="Phone: 419-334-6211"`

guardian.php — Guardianships 8 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Guardianships"`
- Added skip navigation link
- Added `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper
- Added `aria-label` with new tab warnings to all 4 external links
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warnings to all 27 PDF form links across Administration, Emergency, and Successor sections
- Changed all 9 FAQ questions from `<span class="dki-boldhead">` to proper `<h3>` heading elements
- Fixed duplicate `aria-label` attributes on 2 form links (HTML only uses the first occurrence)
- Fixed missing `<p>` opening tag on the last FAQ answer paragraph

adopt.php — Adoptions 5 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Adoption"`
- Added `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper (skip link was already present)
- Fixed malformed `</<h3>` closing tag on "WHAT IS AN OPEN ADOPTION?" heading
- Added `aria-label` with new tab warnings to all 5 external links
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warnings to all 9 adoption form PDF links

trusts.php — Trusts 6 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Trusts"`
- Added skip navigation link
- Removed invalid `<p>` wrapper around `<ul>` in Types of Trusts section
- Added `aria-label` with new tab warnings to both Sandusky County Title Office map links
- Added descriptive `aria-label` to vehicle "SEARCH HERE" link: *"Search vehicle title information on Sandusky County website (opens in new tab)"*
- Added descriptive `aria-label` to watercraft "SEARCH HERE" link: *"Search watercraft title information on Sandusky County website (opens in new tab)"*
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warnings to all 8 trust form PDF links

mental.php — Mental Health 5 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Mental Health"`
- Added descriptive `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warning to "SEARCH HERE" Declaration form link
- Added `aria-label` with new tab warnings to all 3 Mental Health Resources external links (NAMI National, NAMI Seneca/Sandusky/Wyandot, Firelands Counseling)
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warning to Ohio Declaration for Mental Health Treatment form link in Forms section

birthregcorrections.php — Birth Registration and Corrections 10 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Birth Registration and Corrections"` (corrected from incorrect "Mental Health" copy)
- Fixed markdown syntax appearing as literal text in 3 external website links:
`www.scpublichealth.com`, `www.odh.ohio.gov`, and `www.oh-paternity.com`
- Added descriptive `aria-label` to Case Management System "here" link
- Added descriptive `aria-label` to internal "SEARCH HERE" court costs link
- Added `aria-label="Phone: 419-..."` to all 5 phone number `tel:` links on the page
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warning to inline HEA 2745 and HEA 2782 links in Delayed Registration procedure
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warning to inline HEA 2783 link in Correcting Birth Records procedure
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warning to both "Evidence" PDF list links
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warnings to all 3 Forms section PDF links
- Changed all 3 FAQ questions from `<span class="dki-boldhead">` inside `<p>` to proper `<h3>` heading elements

marriagelicense.php — Marriage License 5 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Marriage License"`
- Added `aria-label="100 N. Park Ave., Fremont, OH 43420 (opens in new tab)"` to courthouse map link
- Added `aria-label="Licensed Ministers on Ohio Secretary of State website (opens in new tab)"` to Licensed Ministers link
- Added `aria-hidden="true"` to decorative Material icon inside the Apply Online submit button
- Changed invalid `<p>` wrapper around `<form>` element to `<div>`

disinterment.php — Disinterment 2 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Disinterment"` (corrected from incorrect "Death License" copy)
- Added descriptive `aria-label` with new tab warning to "SEARCH HERE" Ohio Supreme Court forms link

namechange.php — Name Change 7 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Name Change"` (corrected from incorrect "Disinterment" copy)
- Fixed malformed `<stong>` tag (missing "r") in Minor Name Change section
- Added descriptive `aria-label` to all 4 internal "SEARCH HERE" court cost links — correctly distinguishing Name Change filing cost vs. certified copy cost in both Adult and Minor sections
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warnings to all 3 inline Adult section form links
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warnings to all 4 inline Minor section form links
- Added `aria-label` with PDF and new tab warnings to all 6 Forms section PDF links
- Added `aria-label="Phone: 614-466-2531"` to both phone `tel:` links

otherlinks.php — Other Links 3 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Other Links"`
- Added skip navigation link and `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper
- Added `aria-label="[link name] (opens in new tab)"` to all 20 external links; also removed a trailing space from the `www.scpublichealth.com` URL

contact.php — Contact 6 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Contact"`
- Added skip navigation link and `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper
- Wrapped contact address block in semantic `<address>` element
- Added `aria-label="100 N. Park Ave., Fremont, OH 43420 (opens in new tab)"` to courthouse map link
- Converted plain text phone number to `<a href="tel:...">` with `aria-label="Phone: 419-334-6211"`
- Added `aria-label="Fax: 419-334-6210"` to fax number for screen reader clarity

court.php — Court / Judge / Court Costs 10 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Court"`
- Added skip navigation link and `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper
- Added `alt="Judge Brad Smith"` to the Judge's photo — image was missing alt text entirely
- Added `aria-label="100 N. Park Ave., Fremont, OH 43420 (opens in new tab)"` to courthouse map link
- Converted plain text phone number `419-334-6211` to `<a href="tel:...">` with `aria-label`
- Removed invalid `<p>` wrapper around the Legal Holidays `<div>` layout block
- Removed invalid `<p>` wrappers around both `<table>` elements
- Added `<caption class="sr-only">`, `<thead>`, and `<th scope="col">` column headers to Court Costs table
- Added `scope="col"` to all column headers in the Unclaimed Funds table
- Added `aria-label="Phone: 419-334-6217"` to the Amber Broshious contact phone link

localforms.php — Local Forms 5 fixes

- Set page title: `$page_title = "Local Forms"`
- Added skip navigation link and `<main id="main-content">` landmark wrapper
- Added `aria-hidden="true"` to all 10 decorative Material Icons inside collapsible section headers
- Changed 3 subheadings from H3 to H2 — fixed heading skip H1 → H3: Lost/Damaged Wills, Adult Name Change, Minor Name Change
- Added `aria-label="[form name] PDF (opens in new tab)"` to all local form PDF links across all 7 collapsible sections (Adoption, Birth Registration, Estate, Guardianship, Mental Health, Name Change, Trust) and all standalone links

Common Fixes Applied Across All Pages

- **Skip link:** `<a href="#main-content" class="skip-link">Skip to main content</a>` added to every page for keyboard navigation
- **Main landmark:** `<main id="main-content">` added to every page so the skip link target is valid
- **Page titles:** Every page given a unique, descriptive title in the format *Page Name | Sandusky County Probate Court* via dynamic PHP variable
- **Heading hierarchy:** Each page verified to have one H1, with subsections using H2 and H3 in proper order — no skipped levels
- **FAQ headings:** All FAQ questions changed from `<span class="dki-boldhead">` inside `<p>` to semantic `<h3>` elements throughout `estates.php`, `guardian.php`, and `birthregcorrections.php`
- **External links:** All links opening in a new tab include an `aria-label` warning of "(opens in new tab)"
- **PDF links:** All PDF links include "PDF" and "(opens in new tab)" in their `aria-label`
- **Non-descriptive links:** All "SEARCH HERE" and "here" links given descriptive `aria-label` values explaining their destination and purpose
- **Phone links:** All phone numbers converted to `<a href="tel:...">` with `aria-label="Phone: ..."`
- **Invalid HTML:** `<ul>` and `<table>` elements removed from inside `<p>` tags throughout; `<form>` element removed from inside `<p>` tag
- **Malformed tags:** `</h3>` and `<stong>` tag errors corrected in `estates.php`, `adopt.php`, and `namechange.php`
- **Decorative icons:** All Material Icons used for decoration or layout marked with `aria-hidden="true"`
- **Table accessibility:** Data tables given `<caption>` elements and `<th scope="col">` column headers
- **Address markup:** Contact address blocks wrapped in semantic `<address>` elements